Seven foods with no safe dose

Most food charts split the world into safe and toxic. These seven are a third thing: there is no amount that can be called safe, so the answer is never a portion — it is a phone call. The right-hand column is what the vet will ask for.

FOOD	THE DOSE THAT MATTERS
Chocolate	A 10 kg dog shows mild signs from 3–4 oz of milk chocolate, and from under half an ounce of baking chocolate
Grapes and raisins	No threshold has ever been established — three grapes in a 5 kg dog is treated as seriously as a bunch in a 30 kg dog
Xylitol	About 50 mg/kg triggers the insulin crash; around 500 mg/kg risks liver injury
Macadamia nuts	Signs from about 1 g of nut per kg — a couple of nuts for a 10 kg dog
Caffeine	Mild signs from about 20 mg/kg, serious toxicity near 40–60 mg/kg, roughly 140 mg/kg fatal
Alcohol	Lethal at about 5.5–7.9 g of pure ethanol per kg — and it hides in rising dough and fallen fruit
Raw bread dough	Live yeast produces ethanol in a warm stomach while the dough expands inside the dog

> **Remove the food. Keep the packaging. Call your vet or the nearest emergency clinic, and have the dog's weight and roughly how much was eaten ready. Do not make the dog vomit unless a vet tells you to.**

The full chart — 47 foods in four risk tiers, one dose per row — is at **wagwise.org/dog-nutrition/food-safety-chart**. Figures checked against the references listed on that page, 2 November 2026, and re-checked when a source changes. General information, not veterinary advice.